

Runbook: payment authorisation failures

Owner: payments platform. Review cycle: quarterly.

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Symptoms

Authorisation success rate drops while ledger writes stay healthy.

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First checks

Compare payment-gateway pool utilisation against auth-service p99.

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Escalation

Page the auth-service owner, currently Marcus Halvorsen.

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Connection pool exhaustion

If payment-gateway pool utilisation is at 100% and auth-service p99 is above 2 seconds, the gateway is blocked on authentication and the correct action is to roll back the most recent auth-service release, not to restart the gateway.

Restarting the gateway clears the symptom for roughly ninety seconds and then reproduces it.

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Rollback procedure

Emergency change ticket, then rollback, then confirm p99 recovery.

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After the incident

Write the post-mortem within two working days.

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